
☆ Week 12: Medicine and the Body ☆

Hamdy, Sherine. *Our Bodies Belong to God: Organ Transplants, Islam, and the Struggle for Human Dignity in Egypt*

Mastura (Mim) Ritz

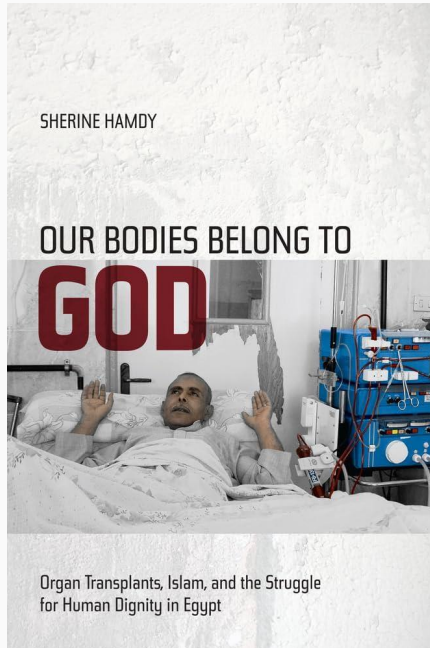
MES327: Seminar - Histories of Science, Nature, and the Body in the Middle East

Sherine Hamdy



- Associate Professor of Anthropology at the University of California Irvine, and previously was a Professor of Anthropology at Brown University
- Research interests:
 - Bioethics
 - Medical Anthropology
 - Contemporary Muslim Ethics
 - Political Economy of Health
- First book published was *Our Bodies Belong to God: Organ Transplants, Islam, and the Struggle for Human Dignity in Egypt* in 2012
- Also works with visual media and is making comics a new medium for anthropology

Synthesis:



Chapter 01:

- Examines organ transplantation ethics in Egypt from 1980s to early 2010s while also considering religious, medical, and political dimensions
- Highlights contradictions in viewpoints from media, state TV, and religious sermons
- Emergence of bioethics in Egypt, calls for broader approach
 - Need to address social and political aspects, including health inequalities
- Highlights evolving nature of ethical considerations amid societal changes

Chapter 05:

- Dr. Abdel Kader Kotb's experiences with organ transplantation in Egypt
 - His pivotal role in Cairo's first successful kidney transplant
 - Ethical and religious reservations about organ transplantation
- Multifaceted ethical, social, and religious discussions involved in organ transplantation decision-making
- Impact of organ transplantation on individuals and communities in Egypt
 - intricate interplay between medical practice, religious beliefs, and societal considerations



Keywords and Concepts:

- Bioethics Rebound
- Islamic Revivalism
- Political Etiology
- Science and Religion
- Expertise



Discussion Questions:

1. How is the field of bioethics understood differently in the Western world vs. Egypt, especially in trying to address social inequalities and individual ethical concerns? Can bioethics be reimagined to incorporate broader social and political worlds?
2. How do ethical considerations intersect with discussions on ensuring equitable access to life-saving medicine, such as organ transplantation? Does this discussion allow for access to all? What does access to all mean?
3. What are the broader implications of religious considerations in medical and bioethics in Egypt?
4. What insights are provided into the experiences of patients and doctors regarding their bodily autonomy and decision-making process in seeking organ transplantation? Does this experience help to make the discussion of organ transplantation any easier?